

# Hudson River School

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Influenced by Romanticism, between c.1825 and 1870, a number of American landscape painters worked around the Hudson River near New York. Although most of the artists had studied in Europe at some point, this was the first native school of painting in the USA. Their paintings depict an American landscape in which humans and nature exist harmoniously together. Paintings are realistic, detailed and often idealized.

Early leaders of the movement were Thomas Doughty (1793–1856), Asher B. Durand (1796–1886) and Thomas Cole (1801–48), all of whom painted carefully observed, atmospheric pictures in the open air. Doughty's serene views were of the river valley itself, Durand's lyrical woodland scenes featured delicate lighting, while Cole preferred stormy, monumental aspects of nature. Along with Albert Bierstadt (1830–1902), Frederic Edwin Church (1826–1900) was the school's most successful painter. Emphasizing light, his panoramic landscapes captured both his home, and travels to areas including Niagara Falls, Labrador, Jamaica, Mexico and the Middle East.



Asher Brown, *The Catskills*, 1859